

A COLLABORATIVE TRAVEL GAME · 1-4 TRAVELERS

REVERIE

The Notebook Game · Pocket Edition

A NOTEBOOK · A PENCIL · TWO DICE · THE WORLD

The Kit

- **One notebook** — the Archive: shared journal, character sheets, and map at once. One per table, passed around; solo travelers keep their own.
- **A pencil.** Pencil, not pen — the world revises.
- **Two d6 in different colors** — the lighter is the **Traveler die**, the darker the **World die**. A third d6 helps.
- **Anything the world offers:** receipts, shells, weather, overheard phrases. All legal game material.

One rule of tone: describe what places *feel* like, not just what's in them. That's the whole philosophy chapter.

How Playing Works

Reverie is a conversation with three interruptions. You talk — where you are, what you do, what you ask. The rules interrupt only when:

- **Uncertain and costly** → make a **Crossing**.
- **Nobody knows** → ask the **Oracle**.
- **Unexplained** → open a **Riddle**.

Everything else simply happens because someone said it. Anyone may add small truths to the world — a rumor, a custom, a smell. Write the good ones down.

Make a Traveler

One notebook page. Five answers, one line each:

- 1 **Road-name.** What are you called out here?
- 2 **Reason.** Why did you begin wandering? Phrase it like a mystery.
- 3 **Keepsake.** One object you always carry. Sketch it small.
- 4 **Burden.** What do you fear becoming? It rides in satchel slot 7.
- 5 **Dream-place.** A place that still appears in your dreams — give it your first echo-mark.

THE BURDEN, AND THE LANTERN'S DIMMER

The Burden is the *traveler's* fear, never the player's — written at whatever distance feels right, rewritable without ceremony. And in every mode, including alone: anyone may pause, redirect, or fade to black, no explanation owed. Shared trust outranks immersion.

Facets

Divide **6 dots** across three facets — max 3, min 1. Draw three empty boxes under each (Weathering).

BONE strength · endurance · steady hands

BREATH nerve · charm · quickness · presence

DREAM intuition · noticing · the uncanny

Satchel

Seven slots; big things take two; the Burden always holds slot 7. Full satchel? Set something down and write *where* — things left behind come back.

The Seven Roads

Six dots make exactly seven spreads (read Bone-Breath-Dream). Choose freely — or roll a d6 among the six unequal spreads. **The Wanderer can only be chosen, never rolled.** Balance is a decision, not a fate.

3·2·1 **Porter** — endures anything, refuses to see omens; carries others' burdens so as not to look at their own.

3·1·2 **Pilgrim** — strong legs, uncanny compass, hopeless with strangers.

2·3·1 **Courier** — delivers everything except bad news; never dreams on the road.

1·3·2 **Busker** — fragile, magnetic, half-listening to something else.

2·1·3 **Dowser** — the body obeys the dream directly, skipping conversation.

1·2·3 **Listener** — frail, quiet, terribly perceptive; the one places confide in.

2·2·2 **Wanderer** — no edge, no blind spot; the road decides.

An archetype is defined by its 1 — the weak facet is where weathering concentrates and crises live. In a band, hold different 1s: each traveler is the protagonist of the scenes another cannot survive. When a Waymark moves a dot, the archetype transmutes — say what changed them.

Waymarks — how travelers change

No experience points. After each passage, write one line: something your traveler now knows, carries, or can't un-see. At each journey's end, do exactly one: **move a facet dot** · **replace the Burden** with a fear earned on the road · or **retire** — the traveler becomes a Figure others may meet.

The Crossing

PROCEDURE

1. Say the attempt and the leading facet.
2. Roll **Traveler d6s = facet dots** — keep the highest.
3. Someone rolls **one World d6**.

Traveler higher → as intended.

Tie → the Threshold Moment (below).

World higher → the world moves; in danger, mark one Weathering box — **two** if the World die won by 3+.

THE TIE — THE THRESHOLD MOMENT

Three things at once: **you succeed; you owe** — roll the Toll; and **the world leans in** — everyone looks up for ten seconds, and the first real thing anyone notices enters the fiction now. One roll in six, novice or master. Spoken Tolls are **dog-eared**: the echo roll collects the debt, transformed.

Weathering & rest

Three boxes per facet. A full facet **closes**: it can't lead, and you show it. All three closed → the **Long Rest** — out of the story until a real day passes. No dying; but the story moves without you. Rest is earned in the fiction — real shelter, a shared meal — and erases **one box, traveler's choice**. Healing slower than the road hurts is what makes the road hard.

How It Shows

Every marked box shows in the fiction — pick or roll a d6 and write the line beside the box.

Weathering is the road writing on the traveler.

WEATHERED BONE (D6)

1 a limp that shortens each day's road · 2 hands that won't stop trembling · 3 an old wound reopened · 4 sleep that doesn't rest · 5 the satchel heavier than its slots · 6 a cough that answers the cold

WEATHERED BREATH (D6)

1 words arriving wrong, or late · 2 unable to hold a stranger's eye · 3 the laugh stops coming · 4 flinching at doors and knocks · 5 speaking only when spoken to · 6 your road-name sounding like someone else's

WEATHERED DREAM (D6)

1 sleep without dreams · 2 missing the obvious omen · 3 distrusting your own noticing · 4 every place feeling like nowhere · 5 the margins reading as scribbles · 6 constant déjà vu meaning nothing

Closed Bone: the body refuses the road. Closed Breath: the traveler goes silent, unreachable.

Closed Dream: the world goes flat — no omens land. The table should see which facet closed without asking.

The Oracle

PROCEDURE

1. Ask a yes/no question aloud. 2. Roll the World d6. 3. The player to the asker's **left** offers the first reading; the table refines. Solo: write question, roll, write the answer before you think too hard.

1	No — and it worsens
2	No
3	No — but a door opens
4	Yes — but a price shows
5	Yes
6	Yes — and it deepens

Two habits keep it alive: ask only what you truly don't know, and take the first honest reading. The oracle needn't be dice — a coin, the next song, the color of the next car. Agree the reading *before* consulting it.

Riddles

A strange situation with no author — nobody knows the truth, not even whoever introduced it. You solve it like a black story: by asking. But the answer doesn't exist yet. It is *assembled*.

- ¹ **Pose it.** Roll d66 on the Fragment table, use something prepared, or something genuinely odd from the real day. Fresh page.
- ² **Question it.** Yes/no questions in turns; the Oracle answers. An *invented* riddle's poser may answer up to two questions directly across its life — their only secret. Rolled riddles have no poser. Solo: Oracle-only.
- ³ **Keep the tally.** Every clear answer is an established fact, one line. *No, and...* crosses one out, asker's choice.
- ⁴ **Tell the truth.** At **seven facts**, anyone may attempt the telling, weaving in at least five. Each other player adds or bends one sentence. Then it's canon.

Riddles needn't resolve in one sitting — dog-ear the page and let echoes feed it. Some deserve to stay at six facts forever. Past **fifteen questions** the valve opens: tell it with what stands.

Vessels

- 1 **Find** it in the actual world; place it on the table or sketch it.
- 2 **Circle it.** One sentence each: who held it, what it wants, what it cost. Solo: three quick sentences.
- 3 **Charge it** (d6 table, back pages). The charge is latent — fired only by the world's hand: the lantern-holder's whim, or solo, only on an Oracle twist or Threshold Moment.
- 4 **File it.** Tape, sketch, or press it into the notebook. Carried, it takes a slot.

Echo-marks

MARKING

Whenever something feels charged — an image, phrase, smell, name — draw a small symbol in the margin. Reuse the same symbol when the motif recurs. Dog-ear pages holding unresolved riddles, spoken Tolls, or things left behind.

ECHOING — START OF EVERY SESSION

1-2 last session's pages · **3-4** any dog-eared page, eyes closed · **5-6** oldest unresolved mark.

Pick one marked thing. It must return this session — **transformed**: same motif, different vessel. Don't force it early.

The Passage

Twenty minutes on a delayed train or three hours at a kitchen table — same shape:

- ¹ **Threshold.** One breath of silence, then one vivid image — from the table, the keeper, or the actual window, made strange.
- ² **Wander.** Travel, talk, notice. Ask what places feel like.
- ³ **Fragment.** When energy dips, roll d66. Open a riddle if it bites.
- ⁴ **Crossing.** At least one moment where someone risks what matters.
- ⁵ **Echo.** The session's echo must have landed by now — if not, land it.
- ⁶ **Residue.** Each player names one image they'll remember; write and mark them. End there — resonance, not closure.

Journeys, briefly

Passages belong to **journeys**: a name, an anchor (a destination · a real trip · a season of six passages), and one open question the journey walks toward — a slow riddle, tallied across sessions. Waymarks resolve at journeys' ends; between journeys all weathering heals and everything unresolved survives. Each new journey must transform something the last one left standing. The full chapter lives on the Shelf.

Modes of Play

Solo — you and the book

Write → ask → roll → write. Short lines; a question every three lines; Crossings against the World die yourself. A passage fits fifteen minutes on a bench. Interpret oracle twists through your most recent echo-mark.

Duo — trading the lantern

The holder frames the world and voices its people; the other acts. **The lantern passes at doors** — any threshold in the fiction — and every Threshold Moment passes it too. The holder's traveler responds but never initiates; the holder's questions go to the Oracle. And only your companion can erase your weathering: rest is a scene of care.

Table — three or four, rotating keeper

No permanent GM. Each passage the lantern passes; the keeper prepares exactly three things: **an opening image, one fragment, one tension** — and the image must transform a residue from the previous passage. The keeper plays their traveler quietly and answers all "what does this place feel like?" questions in character. Every invented truth must attach to something already written.

The lantern is passed, not held. The story is whoever's hands are warm.

The Tables

Toll — on a tie (d6)

- 1 something small stays behind
- 2 a kept truth is spoken
- 3 a promise; the world collects
- 4 it takes too long; dusk comes
- 5 someone learns your road-name
- 6 the place remembers you passed

Charge — a new Vessel (d6)

- 1 cold near untruth
- 2 hums where the dead are restless
- 3 heavier at night
- 4 points toward something lost
- 5 animals will not touch it
- 6 speaks in dreams — one word, so far

Threshold images (d6)

- 1 white birds around an empty chair
- 2 a lit window, "empty" building
- 3 fog showing only the road behind
- 4 a stranger waving — at you, or past
- 5 laundry where no one lives
- 6 what you see now, made strange

The feel of a place (d6)

- 1 watchful
- 2 grieving
- 3 expectant
- 4 forgetful
- 5 welcoming — a little too much
- 6 holding its breath

Fragments — d66

The living table: once a rolled entry has been used, write its replacement into that cell — earned from the fiction or the real road. Entry by entry, the table becomes yours.

11	every clock a different hour	41	an animal at constant distance
12	warm tea, long abandoned	42	tower lights out, floor by floor
13	a child's drawing of a place ahead	43	a meal for four; three plates used
14	hoofprints where none could stand	44	your handwriting, never been here
15	the broken thing, mended overnight	45	bells at the wrong hour, ignored
16	seven locks; six stand open	46	one extra person in the photo
21	the same face in two crowds	51	a stall selling your dreams
22	fresh flowers, unmarked grave	52	ferryman refuses one fare only
23	a song no one remembers learning	53	ivy grown as letters
24	the water flows the wrong way	54	every dog silent tonight
25	all birds face one direction	55	keys above all doors but one
26	a letter to your road-name	56	rain everywhere but the square
31	a street the map denies	61	an unexplained funeral
32	every mirror faces the wall	62	your order known before you speak
33	apology for what hasn't happened	63	footprints in; none out
34	sea-smell, far from any coast	64	your tune whistled from below
35	chalk on doors, counting down	65	old bridge new; new bridge old
36	a statue locals dispute	66	your name crossed out of records

